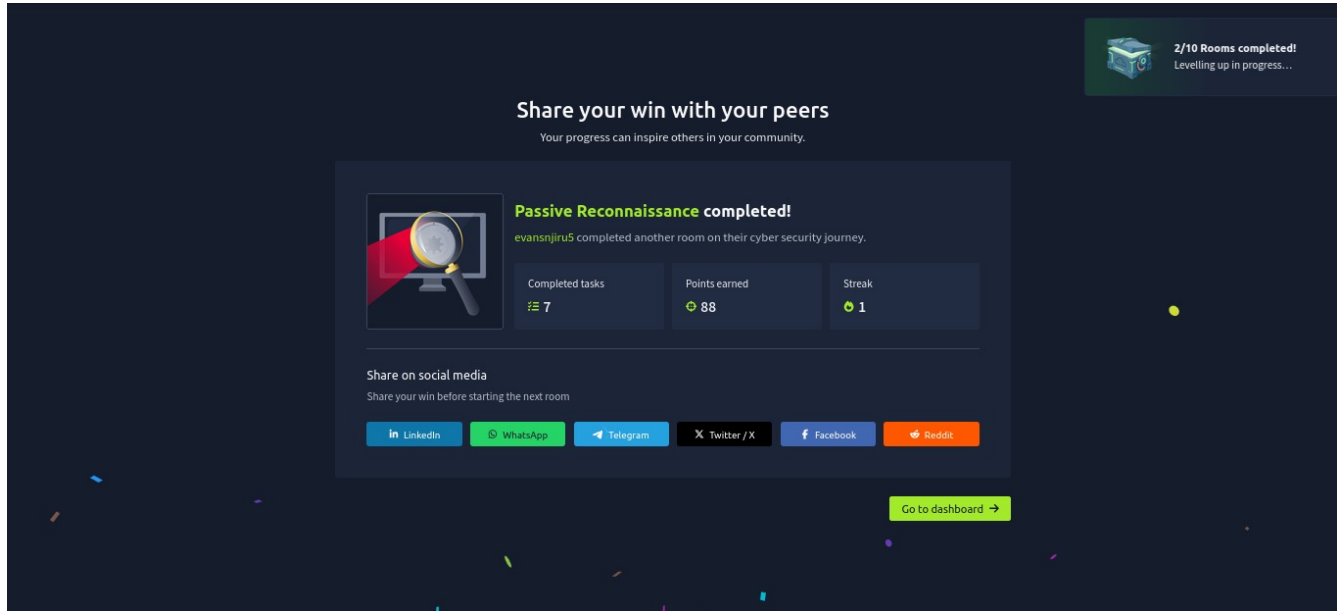


NAME: Alex Mbogo  
GMAIL: evansnjiru5@gmail.com  
ADMISSION NUMBER: ADC-CSS02-25064

## Passive Reconnaissance Module Completion Badge



### 1:1 Passive Reconnaissance

In passive reconnaissance, you rely on publicly available knowledge. It is the knowledge that you can access from publicly available resources without directly engaging with the target



Examples of active reconnaissance activities include:

- Connecting to one of the company servers such as HTTP, FTP, and SMTP.
- Calling the company in an attempt to get information (social engineering).
- Entering company premises pretending to be a repairman.

Considering the invasive nature of active reconnaissance, one can quickly get into legal trouble unless one obtains proper legal authorisation.

Answer the questions below

You visit the Facebook page of the target company, hoping to get some of their employee names. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this? (A for active, P for passive)

✓ Correct Answer

You ping the IP address of the company webserver to check if ICMP traffic is blocked. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this? (A for active, P for passive)

✓ Correct Answer

You happen to meet the IT administrator of the target company at a party. You try to use social engineering to get more information about their systems and network infrastructure. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this? (A for active, P for passive)

✓ Correct Answer

Task 3  Whois

## 1:2 WHOIS

WHOIS is a request and response protocol that follows the RFC 3912 specification. A WHOIS server listens on TCP port 43 for incoming requests

- Registrar: Via which registrar was the domain name registered?
- Contact info of registrant: Name, organization, address, phone, among other things. (unless made hidden via a privacy service)
- Creation, update, and expiration dates: When was the domain name first registered? When was it last updated? And when does it need to be renewed?
- Name Server: Which server to ask to resolve the domain name?

might consider an attack against the email server of the admin user or the DNS servers, assuming they are owned by your client and fall within the scope of the penetration test.

It is important to note that due to automated tools abusing WHOIS queries to harvest email addresses, many WHOIS services take measures against this. They might redact email addresses, for instance. Moreover, many registrants subscribe to privacy services to avoid their email addresses being harvested by spammers and keep their information private.

On the AttackBox, open the terminal and run the `whois tryhackme.com` command to get the information you need to answer the following questions.

Answer the questions below

When was TryHackMe.com registered?

20180705 ✓ Correct Answer 0

What is the registrar of TryHackMe.com?

namecheap.com ✓ Correct Answer 0

Which company is TryHackMe.com using for name servers?

cloudflare.com ✓ Correct Answer 0

Task 4 ☐ nslookup and dig

Task 5 ☐ DNSDumpster

Give its domain name

shodan.io

Task 7 ☐ Summary

## 1:3 Nslookup and Dig

THM AttackBox (62%)

SERVER DOMAIN\_NAME TYPE

- SERVER is the DNS server that you want to query.
- DOMAIN\_NAME is the domain name you are looking up.
- TYPE contains the DNS record type, as shown in the table provided earlier.

Terminal

```
user@TryHackMe$ dig tryhackme.com MX
; <<>> DiG 9.16.19-RH <<>> tryhackme.com MX
;; global options: +cmd
;; Got answer:
;; ->>HEADER<
```

A quick comparison between the output of `nslookup` and `dig` shows that `dig` returned more information, such as the TTL (Time To Live) by default. If you want to query a `1.1.1.1` DNS server, you can execute `dig @1.1.1.1 tryhackme.com MX`.

Using the AttackBox, open the terminal and use the `nslookup` or `dig` command to get the information you need to answer the following question.

Answer the questions below

Check the TXT records of thmlabs.com. What is the flag there?

THM{a5b8392988ed36acb0272971e438d78} ✓ Correct Answer

Task 5 ☐ DNSDumpster

Shodan.io

Applications Places System Thu 5 Feb, 07:44 AttackBox IP: 10.49.134.230

```
root@ip-10-49-134-230:~# dig thmlabs.com MX
; <<>> DiG 9.18.28-Ubuntu0.20.04.1-Ubuntu <<>> thmlabs.com MX
;; global options: +cmd
;; Got answer:
;; ->>HEADER<< opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 34574
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 0, AUTHORITY: 1, ADDITIONAL: 1
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:
; EDNS: version: 0, flags: udp: 1232
;; QUESTION SECTION:
;thmlabs.com.                IN      MX
;; AUTHORITY SECTION:
thmlabs.com.                 1764    IN      SOA     kip.ns.cloudflare.com. dns.cloudflare.com. 2395612621 10000
2400 604800 1800
;; Query time: 4 msec
;; SERVER: 11853(11) (UDP)
;; WHEN: Thu Feb 05 07:39:20 GMT 2026
;; MSG SIZE rcvd: 98

root@ip-10-49-134-230:~# dig thmlabs.com TXT
; <<>> DiG 9.18.28-Ubuntu0.20.04.1-Ubuntu <<>> thmlabs.com TXT
;; global options: +cmd
;; Got answer:
;; ->>HEADER<< opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 23751
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 1, AUTHORITY: 0, ADDITIONAL: 1
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:
; EDNS: version: 0, flags: udp: 1232
;; QUESTION SECTION:
;thmlabs.com.                IN      TXT
;; ANSWER SECTION:
thmlabs.com.                 300     IN      TXT     "THM{a5b8392988ed36acb0272971e438d78}"
;; Query time: 4 msec
;; SERVER: 11853(11) (UDP)
;; WHEN: Thu Feb 05 07:40:01 GMT 2026
;; MSG SIZE rcvd: 90

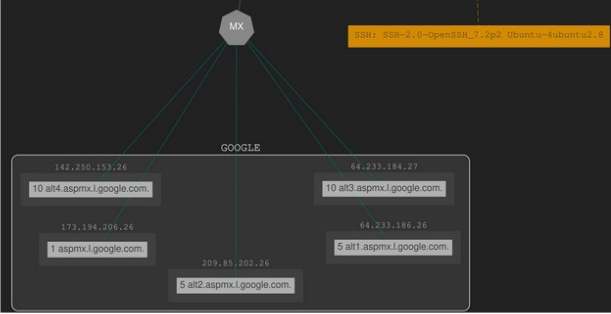
root@ip-10-49-134-230:~#
```

THM AttackBox 48min 37s

## 1:4 DNSDumpster

DnsDumpster looks for domains and Subdomain that can give more information on the target

Room completed (100%)



Use the web browser on the AttackBox, or your system, to answer the following question.

Answer the questions below

Lookup tryhackme.com on DNSDumpster. What is one interesting subdomain that you would discover in addition to www and blog?

✓ Correct Answer

Task 6 Shodan.io

Summary

Applications Places System Thu 5 Feb, 08:35 AttackBox IP: 10.49.134.230

root@ip-10-49-134-230: ~

File Edit View Search Terminal Help

<<> DIG 9.18.28-ubuntu0.20.04.1-Ubuntu <<> thnlabs.com MX  
;; global options: +cnd  
;; Got answer:  
;; -->HEADER<-- opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 36574  
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 0, AUTHORITY: 1, ADDITIONAL: 1  
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:  
;; EDNS: version: 0, flags: udp: 1232  
;; QUESTION SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. IN MX  
;; AUTHORITY SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. 1764 IN SOA klp.ns.cloudflare.com. dns.cloudflare.com. 2395612821 10800 2400 604800 1800  
Query time: 4 msec  
SERVER: ::1#53(:1) (UDP)  
WHEN: Thu Feb 05 07:39:20 GMT 2026  
MSG SIZE rcvd: 98  
root@ip-10-49-134-230:~# dig thnlabs.com TXT  
;<<> DIG 9.18.28-ubuntu0.20.04.1-Ubuntu <<> thnlabs.com TXT  
;; global options: +cnd  
;; Got answer:  
;; -->HEADER<-- opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 23751  
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 1, AUTHORITY: 0, ADDITIONAL: 1  
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:  
;; EDNS: version: 0, flags: udp: 1232  
;; QUESTION SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. IN TXT  
;; ANSWER SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. 300 IN TXT "THM(a5b8392988ed36acb0272971e438d78)"  
Query time: 4 msec  
SERVER: ::1#53(:1) (UDP)  
WHEN: Thu Feb 05 07:40:01 GMT 2026  
MSG SIZE rcvd: 98  
root@ip-10-49-134-230:~#

THM AttackBox 0m 0s

## 1:5 ShodanIO

Shodan.io tries to connect to every device reachable online to build a search engine of connected “things” in contrast with a search engine for web pages. Once it gets a response, it collects all the information related to the service and saves it in the database to make it searchable

Room progress (93%)

- geographic location
- server type and version

You may also try searching for the IP addresses you have obtained from DNS lookups. These are, of course, more subject to change. On their [help page](#), you can learn about all the search options available at Shodan.io, and you are encouraged to join TryHackMe's Shodan.io.

It would be best to visit Shodan.io to answer the following questions; however, note that you can find the answers on Shodan.io without needing a premium account.

Answer the questions below

According to Shodan.io, what is the first country in the world in terms of the number of publicly accessible Apache servers?

✓ Correct Answer

Based on Shodan.io, what is the 3rd most common port used for Apache?

✓ Correct Answer

Based on Shodan.io, what is the most common port used for nginx?

✓ Correct Answer

Task 7 Summary

How likely are you to recommend this room to others?

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6 ☐ 7 ☐ 8 ☐ 9 ☐ 10

Applications Places System Thu 5 Feb, 08:10 AttackBox IP: 10.49.134.230

root@ip-10-49-134-230: ~

File Edit View Search Terminal Help

<<> DIG 9.18.28-ubuntu0.20.04.1-Ubuntu <<> thnlabs.com MX  
;; global options: +cnd  
;; Got answer:  
;; -->HEADER<-- opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 36574  
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 0, AUTHORITY: 1, ADDITIONAL: 1  
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:  
;; EDNS: version: 0, flags: udp: 1232  
;; QUESTION SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. IN MX  
;; AUTHORITY SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. 1764 IN SOA klp.ns.cloudflare.com. dns.cloudflare.com. 2395612821 10800 2400 604800 1800  
Query time: 4 msec  
SERVER: ::1#53(:1) (UDP)  
WHEN: Thu Feb 05 07:39:20 GMT 2026  
MSG SIZE rcvd: 98  
root@ip-10-49-134-230:~# dig thnlabs.com TXT  
;<<> DIG 9.18.28-ubuntu0.20.04.1-Ubuntu <<> thnlabs.com TXT  
;; global options: +cnd  
;; Got answer:  
;; -->HEADER<-- opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 23751  
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 1, AUTHORITY: 0, ADDITIONAL: 1  
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:  
;; EDNS: version: 0, flags: udp: 1232  
;; QUESTION SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. IN TXT  
;; ANSWER SECTION:  
; thnlabs.com. 300 IN TXT "THM(a5b8392988ed36acb0272971e438d78)"  
Query time: 4 msec  
SERVER: ::1#53(:1) (UDP)  
WHEN: Thu Feb 05 07:40:01 GMT 2026  
MSG SIZE rcvd: 98  
root@ip-10-49-134-230:~#

THM AttackBox 22min 34s